

Docs

1. Overview

1.1 Introduction

A10 Control is A10 Networks' centralized management and analytics platform for secure application services. It provides a single point of management for A10 Thunder devices, including physical, virtual, and cloud instances, across your on-premises data centers and clouds, while offering real-time visibility into application traffic and device performance. Think of it as a control tower for your network: all device management, traffic analytics, licensing, and alerts are handled from one web interface.

The following figure shows a high-level architecture of the A10 Control platform and its interaction with managed devices.

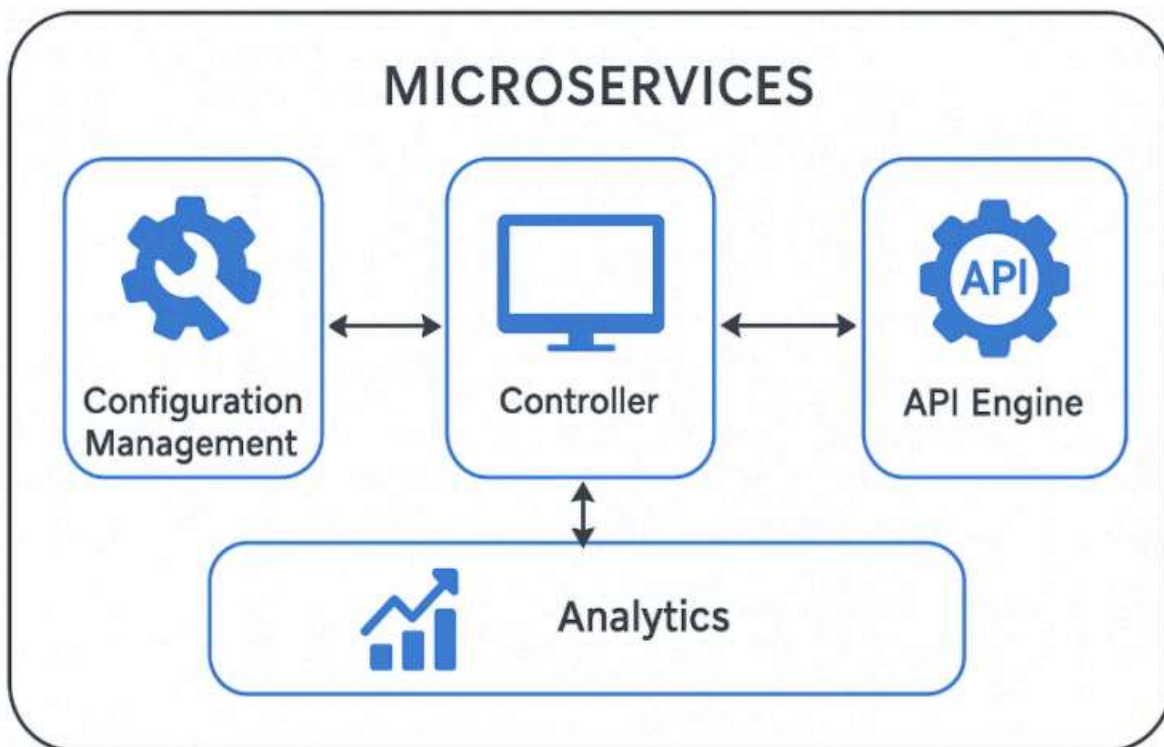


Figure 1. High-level architecture of A10 Control platform

1.2 Audience

This guide is for first-time network administrators who want to start using the A10 Control platform.

1.3 Why use A10 Control

Managing multiple Thunder devices individually requires logging into each device separately, which is timeconsuming and error-prone at scale. A10 Control consolidates that work into one interface. The table below summarizes the key benefits.

Benefit	Discription
Centralized management	Manage all Thunder devices from one web interface. No more per-device logins for routine tasks.
Real-time visibility	See live traffic throughput, connection rates, CPU and memory usage, and device health across your entire network.
Multi-tenant isolation	Divide access across teams using Organizations and Org Units. Each team sees and manages only its own resources.
Role-based access control	Assign granular permissions per user. Control who can view, configure, or delete resources without sharing admin credentials.
Centralized licensing	Manage all Thunder device licenses from one place using FlexPool licenses instead of configuring each device separately.
Automated alerting	Set threshold-based alerts and receive email or webhook notifications so you are informed before issues become outages.
Scheduled reports	Generate on-demand or automated reports for inventory, bandwidth usage, and application performance.

1.4 Key concepts

The following terms appear throughout this guide and in the A10 Control interface. Review them before proceeding.

Term	Definition
Thunder device	An A10 Networks appliance (physical, virtual, or cloud-based) that processes application traffic. A10 Control manages these devices.
ACOS	Advanced Core Operating System. The OS that runs on every Thunder device. A10 Control 1.4 supports ACOS 6.0.5-SP1 and later. ACOS 6.0.8 and 7.0.2 are recommended for full feature alignment.
Controller / super-admin	The highest-level administrator. Installs A10 Control, creates Organizations, and manages platform-wide settings. The default username is super-admin.
Organization	A top-level tenant account, similar to a company or department. Each Organization has its own admin users, devices, and resources, fully isolated from other Organizations.
Org Unit (OU)	A subdivision within an Organization used to delegate administration to smaller teams or projects. Each Org Unit manages its own application services independently.
Cluster	A logical grouping of one or more Thunder devices that work together to deliver application services. All devices must belong to a cluster.
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control. Defines what each user is allowed to do: view, configure, or manage specific resources within a given scope.
Access Group	Links a role to a specific set of resources. Users are assigned to Access Groups, not directly to roles.

FlexPool license	A pooled device license shared across multiple Thunder devices. Devices draw from the pool when they register and return capacity when they deregister.
GLM / ALM	Global License Manager (internet-connected) and A10 Control License Manager (offline/air-gapped). These systems activate and distribute licenses.

1.5 Role-Based Access Control

Role	Default username	Key responsibilities
Controller	super-admin	Manages the platform itself. Creates organizations, configures system settings, activates licenses, and monitors overall platform health.
Organization	org-admin	Manages devices, Org Units, users, and licenses within a single organization. Cannot view other organizations.
Org Unit	tenant-admin	Manages and monitors application services within a single Org Unit. Cannot access other Org Units.

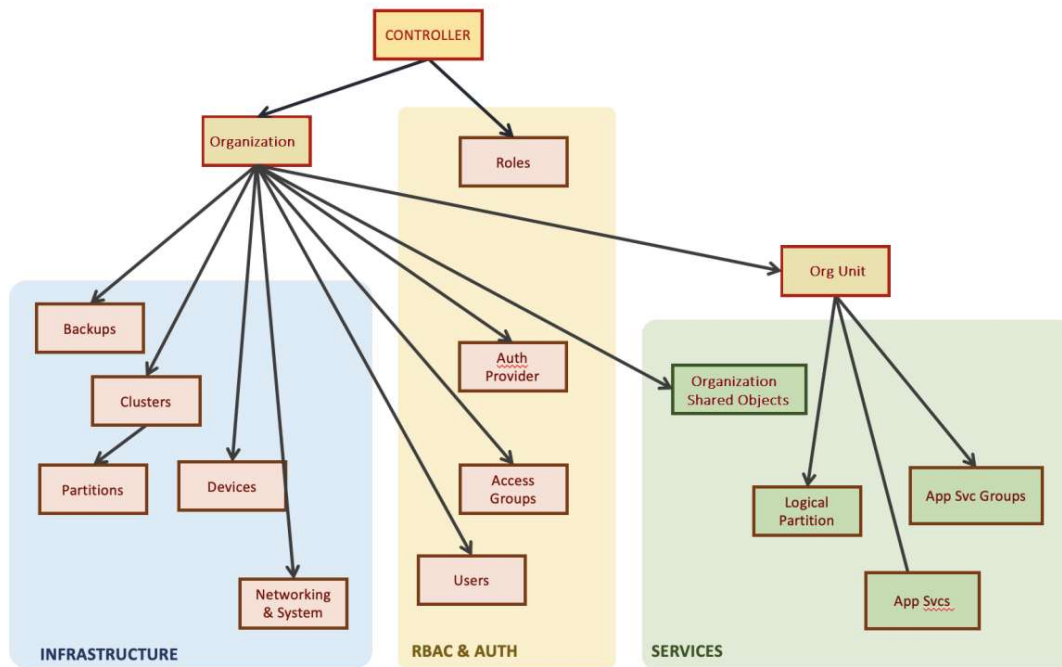


Figure 2. Role-Based Access Control

2. Initial setup

2.1 Deployment options

A10 Control is installed as a virtual machine on a supported hypervisor. Two variants are available.

Variant	Use when
A10 Control Lite (Standalone only)	Managing up to 10 ADC or 5 ADO/TPS devices. Lower infrastructure requirements.
A10 Control Standard (Standalone or Multi-node cluster)	Moderate to large scale. Multi-node provides high availability. Supports ADC, CGN, ADO, SSLi, and GiFW.

2.2 System requirements

2.2.1 Supported platforms

- VMware ESXi 8.0 or higher (UEFI firmware recommended)
- KVM on Red Hat Enterprise Linux 9.4 or 9.6 (NTP must be enabled on the hypervisor)

2.2.2 Minimum compute requirements

Deployment type	CPU (cores)	RAM	Disk (SSD)
A10 Control Lite	16	64 GB	700 GB
A10 Control Standard	32	128 GB	700 GB

Note: These values are for evaluation and lab environments only. For production sizing, refer to the sizing tables in the A10 Control installation documentation.

2.3 Network prerequisites

2.3.1 Required open ports

The following ports must be open for inbound traffic before installation.

Port	Protocol	Purpose
443	TCP	Web browser access to the A10 Control GUI/API. Used by registered Thunder devices for management communication.
25500	TCP	Secure tunnel between A10 Control and Thunder devices.
9094	TCP	Analytics and telemetry data received from Thunder devices.
2222	TCP	SSH access for device configuration, backups, file transfers, and upgrades.
53	UDP	DNS name resolution.
6343	UDP	sFlow telemetry (ADO/TPS Mitigator and Detector devices only).

2.3.2 Information to gather before installation

Item	Description
A10 Control ISO image	Download from the A10 Networks Support portal. Verify the checksum after downloading.
Management IP address	Assigned to the A10 Control management interface. Used to access the GUI after installation.
Floating IP address	Shared IP for GUI access in multi-interface or multi-node deployments.
Gateway IP address	Default gateway for the management subnet.
NTP server IP	Required for time synchronization. A drift over 30 seconds between A10 Control and Thunder devices causes analytics issues.
DNS server IP	Required to resolve external URLs including GLM and the email server. Without DNS, license activation fails.
License entitlement token	Sent by email when you purchase A10 Control. Required to activate the platform license.

3. Access and login

3.1 First-time login

After installation completes (up to two hours), access the A10 Control web interface from a supported browser.

3.1.1 Supported browsers

- Google Chrome – version 143.0.7499.40 or later
- Mozilla Firefox – version 145.0.2 or later
- Microsoft Edge – version 143.0.3650.96 or later

3.1.2 To login for the first time

1. Open a web browser and enter the following URL:
`https://<management-ip>`
2. On the Login page, enter the default organization as **root** and click **Next**.
3. On the Organization Login Credential page, enter the default credentials:
Username: super-admin
Password: Password@123
4. Click **Login**.
5. When prompted, reset the password before continuing.
6. Review and accept the License Agreement. The A10 Control Home page appears.

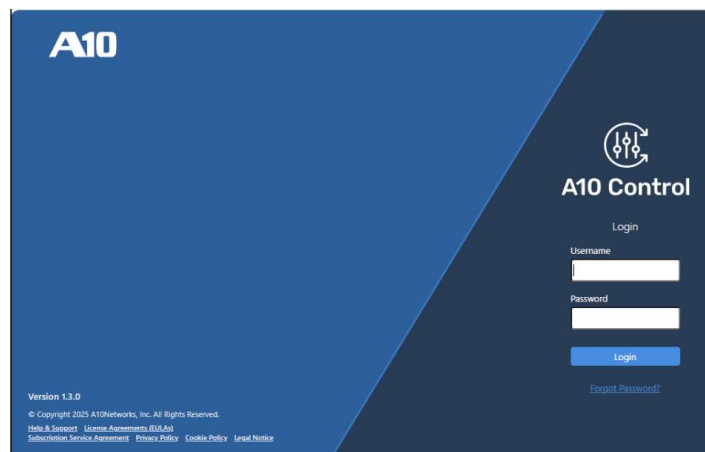


Figure 3. A10 Control login page

Note: The GUI password and CLI password are separate. Changing one does not change the other.

The default CLI password is OnPr@mSym\$2023##. Change it after first login by running `sudo passwd`.

3.2 Basic system configuration

After first login, complete these configuration tasks in the controller scope before adding devices or organizations.

3.2.1 Configure DNS

Go to **Settings >> System >> General >> DNS**. Add a primary DNS server IP address. Without DNS, A10

Control cannot resolve the GLM portal, email server, or LDAP addresses.

3.2.2 Configure NTP

Go to **Settings** >> **System** >> **General** >> **NTP**. Add your NTP server and enable synchronization. A time drift over 30 seconds between A10 Control and managed Thunder devices disrupts analytics.

3.2.3 Configure the email server

Go to **Settings** >> **System** >> **Notifications** >> **Email**. Enter your SMTP server details. Email is required for storage threshold alerts, license expiry warnings, and user onboarding notifications.

3.2.4 Activate the license

Go to **Platform** >> **License Management**. Configure the license manager and import your license token.

License manager	Use when
Global License Manager (GLM)	A10 Control has internet access. Default option. Licenses activated directly with the GLM portal.
A10 Control License Manager (ALM)	No internet access. Air-gapped or offline environments. Activate ALM once through GLM, then manage licenses locally.

Important: A 30-day trial license is activated automatically at installation. Import a production license within 30 days to avoid service interruption.

3.3 Create your first organization

An organization is the top-level tenant account in A10 Control. Create at least one organization before registering devices or assigning users.

3.3.1 To create an organization

1. In the navigation menu, go to **Organizations >> Manage Organization**.
2. Click **Add**.
3. Enter the **Organization name** and **Display name**.
4. Provide the required contact details.
5. Click **Save**.

A default **org-admin** user is created automatically.

3.3.2 To obtain org-admin credentials

1. In the organization list, open the **More actions (:)** menu.
2. Click **Reset password**.
3. Choose **Email credentials** or **Download credentials**.

4. Monitoring and dashboards

After you sign in and register devices, use dashboards to monitor platform status and traffic analytics.

4.1 Dashboard overview

A10 Control provides dashboards at two scopes:

- **Controller scope** – Shows platform health and system resource usage
- **Organization scope** – Shows device performance and traffic analytics

Use the **scope selector** at the top of the page to switch between views.

4.2 System health

Go to **Dashboard >> System Health**.

The System Health dashboard shows the operational status of the A10 Control platform itself.

Use this dashboard to confirm that controller nodes are functioning correctly after installation.

Tab	What it shows
Compute	Real-time CPU and memory usage for each node with trend graphs.
Storage	Disk utilization per node and storage threshold alerts.
Network	View-only display of network interface configuration and floating IP settings.

Note: Configure the email server so that storage alerts are received before capacity limits are reached.

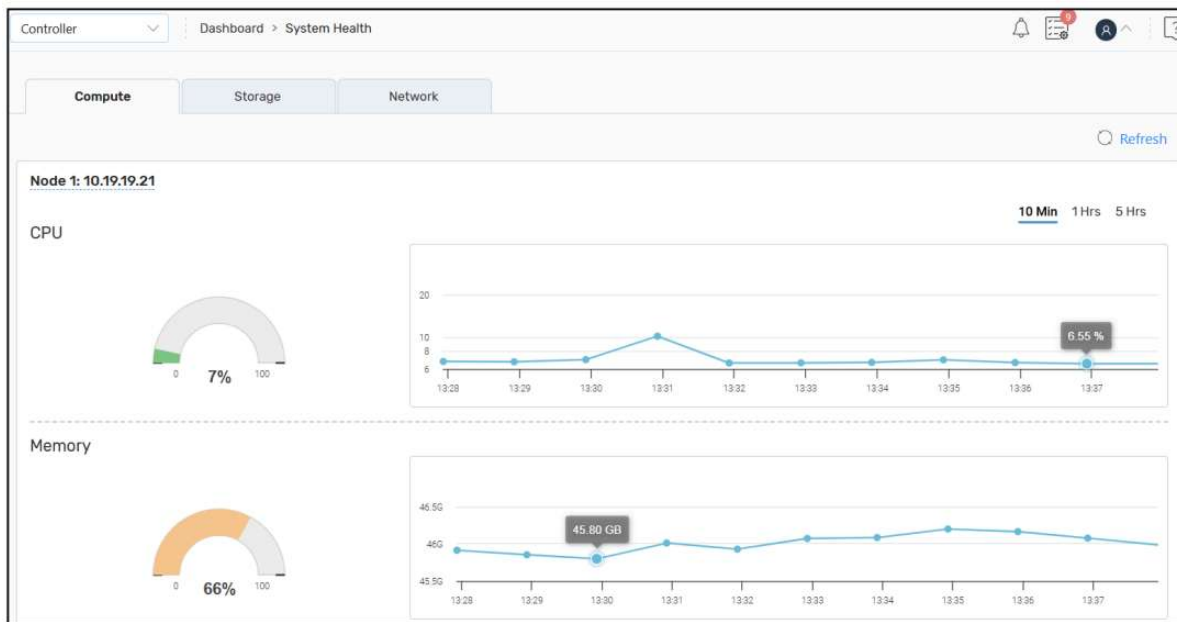


Figure 4. System Health dashboard

4.3 Telemetry statistics

Go to **Dashboard >> Telemetry Stats**.

Telemetry Stats shows how log processing capacity is used across organizations.

Widget	What it shows
Log Processing Capacity	Average log processing utilization and trend indicators.
Log Sharing	Distribution of processing capacity across organizations.
Log Processing Rate	Number of logs processed per second over time.
Capacity Usage	Capacity consumption trends per organization.

Note: Single-node deployments support lower log ingestion capacity compared to multi-node deployments.

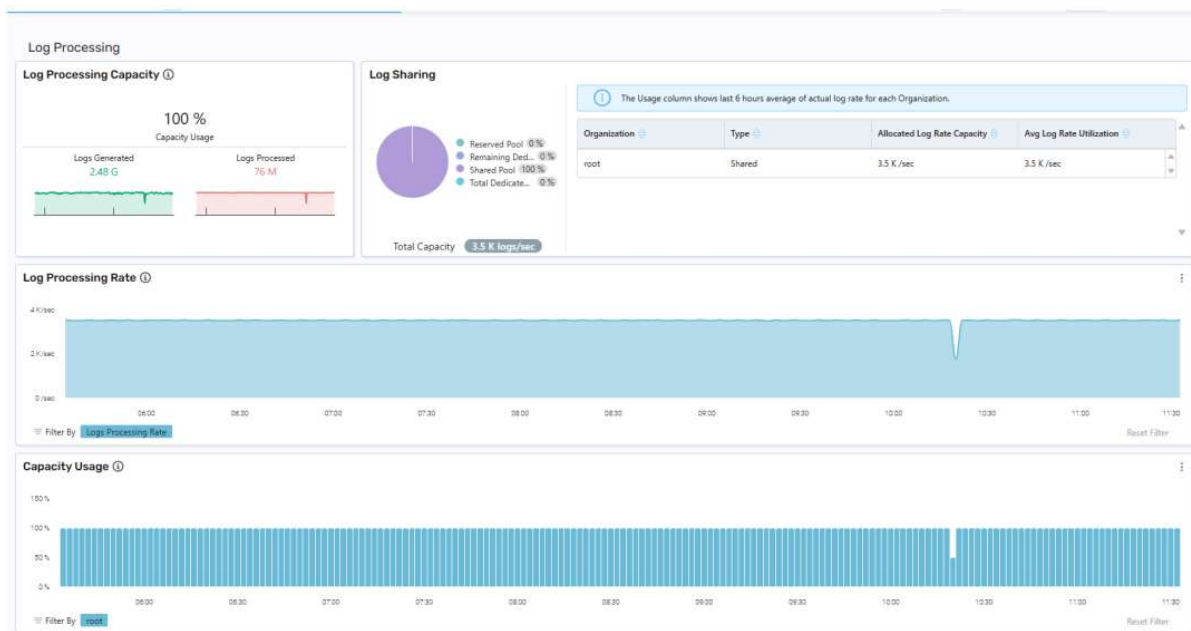


Figure 5. Telemetry statistics dashboard

4.4 Device analytics

Go to **Infrastructure >> Devices**, select a device, and open the **Analytics** tab.

Device analytics dashboards become available after at least one Thunder device is registered.

The following performance metrics are displayed:

- Throughput trends for ingress and egress traffic
- Connection rate statistics and active session count
- CPU, memory, disk, and session utilization
- Alert events and system notifications

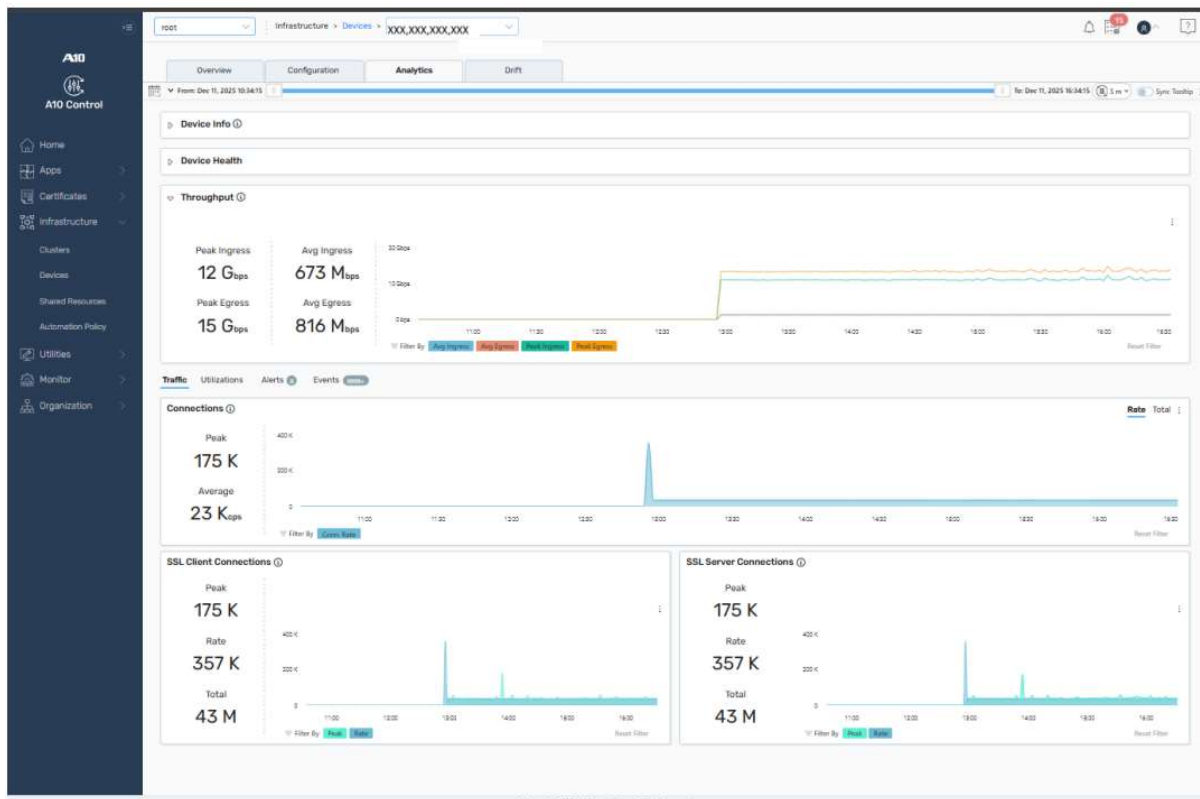


Figure 6. Device analytics dashboard

5. Initial management tasks

After completing initial setup and first login, perform the following tasks to begin managing your network using A10 Control.

5.1 Create a cluster

Go to **Infrastructure >> Clusters >> Click Create.**

A cluster is a logical grouping of one or more Thunder devices. You must create a cluster before you can register any device.

5.2 Register a device

Go to **Infrastructure >> Devices >> Click Add.**

Register a Thunder device to a cluster. The device requires a valid FlexPool license to complete registration. You will select the license and allocate bandwidth during the registration workflow.

Note: Before registering, confirm the device runs a supported ACOS version. ACOS 6.0.8 and 7.0.2 are recommended for full feature support with A10 Control 1.4. See the A10 Control and ACOS Compatibility Matrix.

5.3 Create an org unit

Go to **Organization >> Org Units >> Click Create.**

An org unit subdivides an organization to support team-level management. After creating an org unit, provision the cluster to it so that analytics data can be collected.

To provision a cluster:

1. Go to **Infrastructure >> Clusters**.
2. Open the **More actions (:)** menu for the required cluster and click **Provision**.
3. Map the required device partitions to the org unit.
4. click **Provision**.

Note: Analytics data does not appear in dashboards until at least one device partition is provisioned to an org unit.

5.4 Add users and roles

Go to **Organization >> Users & Permissions**.

A10 Control uses role-based access control (RBAC) to manage user permissions. Create access groups, assign roles to those groups, and then associate users with the required access groups.

To configure user access:

1. Go to **Users & Permissions >> Access Groups** and select **Create**.
2. Select a predefined role and define the resource scope.
3. Go to **Users & Permissions >> Users** and select **Create**.
4. Enter the user details and assign one or more access groups.
5. Send credentials using **More actions (:)** >> **Reset password**.

5.5 Configure alerts

Go to **Monitor >> Alerts**.

Alerts notify administrators when defined conditions occur on clusters, devices, or partitions.

To configure alerts:

1. Create an **action** to define the notification method (email or webhook).
2. Create a **trigger** to define the alert condition.
3. Create an **alert** to link the trigger and action to a resource.

Note: Configure the SMTP email server in **Settings >> System >> Notifications >> Email** to receive alert notifications.